

YHWH's Design for Marriage

From the Garden to the Wedding Supper of the Lamb

A Kingdom Life teaching study. Scripture quoted from the WEB, divine name rendered YHWH, Elohim, and Adonai.

THE HEART OF IT

Marriage was not invented by a church, a government, or a culture. YHWH designed it in the garden, before sin, before the instructions were written on stone, before there was a nation of Israel. And from the first page of Scripture to the last, He uses marriage to show us Himself: a Husband who makes covenant, keeps covenant, forgives, pursues, and comes back for His bride.

IN THIS STUDY

The Marriage Thread

- I. Marriage Was His Idea
 - II. A Helper Comparable to Him
 - III. Taken From His Side
 - IV. Leave, Join, Become One
 - V. What Broke in the Garden
 - VI. Marriage Is a Covenant
 - VII. YHWH, the Husband of His People
 - VIII. Yahshua and Marriage
 - IX. The Husband's Part
 - X. The Wife's Part
 - XI. One Flesh in Practice: Bed, Home, and Prayer
 - XII. Forgiveness Keeps the Covenant
 - XIII. The Enemy Hates This Picture
 - XIV. When the Covenant Is Broken
 - XV. The Wedding at the End of the Story
- Reference Tables, Questions for Couples, a Prayer, Cross Reference Index, Notes

This study walks the thread of marriage through the whole of Scripture. It starts in Genesis, where YHWH designs it. It follows the break in the garden, the covenant at Sinai, the prophets who called YHWH a Husband, and Yahshua, who performed His first sign at a wedding and answered every marriage question by going back to the beginning. It ends where Scripture ends: with a wedding.

Take it slowly. Read every verse in your own Bible. Where this handout explains a Hebrew word, check it. Where it states a conviction, it says so plainly, so you can test it against the text for yourself.

COMPANION STUDY

Husbands, this study pairs with the Kingdom Life handout *Husbands, Love Your Wives*, which goes deep on Ephesians 5:25 to 29. Section IX here gives the overview; that handout gives the full study.

SECTION I

Marriage Was His Idea

Elohim created man in his own image. In Elohim's image he created him; male and female he created them.

GENESIS 1:27

Before Scripture tells us anything about roles, it tells us this: male and female, together, bear the image of Elohim. Neither one alone shows the whole picture. The blessing that follows in verse 28, be fruitful, multiply, fill the earth, and subdue it, was spoken to *them*, together.

YHWH Elohim said, "It is not good for the man to be alone. I will make him a helper comparable to him."

GENESIS 2:18

Six times in Genesis 1, Elohim looks at what He made and sees that it is good (verses 4, 10, 12, 18, 21, and 25), and in verse 31 He calls the whole of it very good. Then in Genesis 2 we hear the first **"not good"** in the Bible. Nothing was broken yet. There was no sin. The man walked with his Creator in a perfect garden. And still YHWH said it was not good for him to be alone.

That tells us something important. Marriage is not a backup plan for loneliness, and it is not a concession to sin. It was part of the design before anything went wrong. When Yahshua was asked about marriage, He did not start with culture or with later rules. He went straight back to this: *"from the beginning"* (Matthew 19:4, 8).

KEY TRUTH

If marriage was designed before the fall, then marriage belongs to the "very good." Restoring marriage means restoring what YHWH built in the beginning, not inventing something new.

SECTION II

A Helper Comparable to Him

The phrase "a helper comparable to him" is two Hebrew words: **ezer kenegdo**. Many people hear "helper" and think assistant, junior partner, or someone who fetches things. The Hebrew says the opposite.

Ezer: the word Elohim uses for Himself

Most of the time the word **ezer** appears in the Hebrew Scriptures, it describes Elohim Himself coming to the aid of His people. Moses named his son Eliezer, "my Elohim is help," because Elohim had delivered him from Pharaoh's sword (Exodus 18:4).

My help comes from YHWH, who made heaven and earth.

PSALM 121:2

Our soul has waited for YHWH. He is our help and our shield.

PSALM 33:20

The helper in Scripture is not the weaker one in the room. The helper is the one who brings the strength that is missing.

Kenegdo: corresponding to him, face to face

Kenegdo means corresponding to him, opposite him, standing face to face with him. Not above him, not beneath him, but matching him the way one side of a bridge matches the other.

Notice the order of events in Genesis 2:19 to 20. Before YHWH formed the woman, He brought every animal to the man to be named. The man saw creature after creature come in pairs, and the verse closes: "*but for man there was not found a helper comparable to him.*" YHWH let Adam feel the need before He met it.

KEY TRUTH

A wife is not her husband's assistant. She is the strength YHWH sent to stand face to face with him, and the word He chose for her is a word He uses for Himself.

SECTION III

Taken From His Side

YHWH Elohim caused the man to fall into a deep sleep. As the man slept, he took one of his ribs, and closed up the flesh in its place. YHWH Elohim made a woman from the rib which he had taken from the man, and brought her to the man.

GENESIS 2:21-22

The word translated "rib" is **tsela**. Elsewhere it is usually translated **side**. It is the word used for the sides of the ark of the covenant and the sides of the tabernacle (Exodus 25:12; 26:20). The woman was built from the man's side.

The old commentator Matthew Henry made a point many teachers have repeated since: she was not taken from his head to rule over him, nor from his feet to be trampled by him, but from his side to be equal with him, from under his arm to be protected, and from near his heart to be loved.

The Father brought the bride

Look at the last line of verse 22: YHWH *brought her to the man*. The very first bride in Scripture was walked to her husband by the Father Himself.

The first recorded words of man

The man said, "This is now bone of my bones, and flesh of my flesh. She will be called 'woman,' because she was taken out of Man."

GENESIS 2:23

These are the first words of the man that Scripture records, and they are a song over his bride. In Hebrew he is **ish** and she is **ishah**. Her name carries his, and his recognition of her carries joy: *at last, this one.*

A picture of the Bridegroom to come

Adam was put into a deep sleep, his side was opened, and from that opened side came his bride. Thousands of years later the last Adam hung on a tree.

However one of the soldiers pierced his side with a spear, and immediately blood and water came out.

JOHN 19:34

From the opened side of Yahshua came the blood that cleanses and the water that washes, and from that His bride is formed. Paul says the first marriage was always pointing here (Ephesians 5:31-32).

SECTION IV

Leave, Join, Become One

Therefore a man will leave his father and his mother, and will join with his wife, and they will be one flesh.

GENESIS 2:24

This one verse is quoted by Yahshua (Matthew 19:5) and by Paul (Ephesians 5:31). It holds three verbs, and every marriage lives or dies on them.

1. Leave

The word is **azav**, to leave behind, to let go. It does not cancel honoring your father and mother (Exodus 20:12). It changes the order. Your parents' approval, your parents' household, and your parents' way of doing things no longer come first. Your spouse does. Many marriages struggle not because the couple never married, but because one of them never left.

2. Join

The word is **dabaq**, to cling, to stick, to hold fast. It is the word used of Ruth when she clung to Naomi and would not let go (Ruth 1:14). It is also the word YHWH uses for how His people are to hold to Him:

You shall fear YHWH your Elohim. You shall serve him. You shall cling to him, and you shall swear by his name.

DEUTERONOMY 10:20

The same clinging that belongs to YHWH in worship is the clinging a husband gives his wife in marriage. That is how seriously Scripture takes the joining.

3. Become one

The word for one is **echad**. It is the same word in the great declaration of Israel:

Hear, Israel: YHWH is our Elohim. YHWH is one.

DEUTERONOMY 6:4

Echad can describe a unity made of more than one part: evening and morning were one day (Genesis 1:5); two people become one flesh. Marriage does not erase the husband or the wife. It joins two whole people into one life before Elohim.

The man and his wife were both naked, and they were not ashamed.

GENESIS 2:25

Nothing hidden. Nothing covered. Nothing to prove. That is the original design. In the next chapter, the very first thing sin does is make them cover themselves and hide (Genesis 3:7-8).

KEY TRUTH

Leave, join, become one. Every marriage problem can be traced to one of these three: someone who never left, someone who stopped clinging, or two people who are living as two instead of one.

SECTION V

What Broke in the Garden

The first attack of the enemy recorded in Scripture was not on a nation or a temple. It was on a marriage.

...she took some of its fruit, and ate; and she gave some to her husband with her, and he ate it.

GENESIS 3:6

With her. The man was there. In Genesis 2:15, YHWH had put him in the garden "to cultivate and keep it." The word for keep is **shamar**, to guard, to watch over. The guard stood silent while the serpent spoke to his wife.

Then came the blame

The man said, "The woman whom you gave to be with me, she gave me fruit from the tree, and I ate it."

GENESIS 3:12

In one sentence he blamed his wife and blamed Elohim for giving her to him. The man who sang "bone of my bones" now pointed at her. The woman then blamed the serpent (verse 13). Pride does not confess; it redirects. That pattern still shows up in marriages every day.

A description of the curse, not a blueprint for marriage

Your desire will be for your husband, and he will rule over you.

GENESIS 3:16

The Hebrew word for desire, **teshuqah**, appears only three times in Scripture. The second time is just one chapter later, when YHWH warns Cain that sin is crouching at the door: *"Its desire is for you, but you are to rule over it"* (Genesis 4:7). The language is closely parallel. Read together, many see in 3:16 a struggle for control: a desire to have the upper hand, met by a ruling that crushes. Whatever exact shade you see in it, this verse describes what sin does to a marriage. It is not the design YHWH gave in chapter 2.

The third time the word appears, it is turned around:

I am my beloved's. His desire is toward me.

SONG OF SONGS 7:10

In the garden of the fall, the desire was a struggle. In the garden of the Song, the desire is his, turned toward her in love. That is the direction redemption moves.

HOPE IN THE GARDEN

Even in the curse there was a promise. In Genesis 3:15 YHWH announced the Seed of the woman who would crush the serpent's head. The One who would restore marriage was promised on the very day it broke.

SECTION VI

Marriage Is a Covenant

Yet you say, 'Why?' Because YHWH has been witness between you and the wife of your youth, against whom you have dealt treacherously, though she is your companion, and the wife of your covenant.

MALACHI 2:14

Malachi calls a wife **the wife of your covenant**, and says YHWH Himself is the witness. Proverbs says the same thing from the other side, describing a woman who "forsakes the friend of her youth, and forgets the covenant of her Elohim" (Proverbs 2:17). The marriage covenant is not only between two people. It is made in front of Elohim, and He calls it His.

Did he not make you one, although he had the residue of the Spirit? Why one? He sought godly offspring. Therefore take heed to your spirit, and let no one deal treacherously against the wife of his youth.

MALACHI 2:15

Notice the reason YHWH gives for making them one: He was looking for godly offspring. A faithful marriage is how YHWH intends to raise up the next generation in His ways.

Covenant is not contract

A contract protects my rights and says what I get if you fail. A covenant gives myself and says what I will be even when you fail. Contracts are kept by lawyers. Covenants are kept by faithfulness. YHWH never related to His people by contract. He related to them by covenant, and that is how He designed marriage to work.

If a man prevails against one who is alone, two shall withstand him; and a threefold cord is not quickly broken.

ECCLESIASTES 4:12

In context, Ecclesiastes 4:9-12 is about the strength of companionship. Many apply the third strand to YHWH at the center of the marriage. The verse does not name Him, but the application fits the rest of Scripture: a husband and wife bound to each other and both bound to Him are hard to break.

SECTION VII

YHWH, the Husband of His People

Once you see marriage as covenant, you start to see that YHWH describes His own covenant with Israel as a marriage, again and again.

Sinai: the wedding in the wilderness

Go, and proclaim in the ears of Jerusalem, saying, 'YHWH says, "I remember for you the kindness of your youth, your love as a bride, how you went after me in the wilderness, in a land that was not sown."'

JEREMIAH 2:2

At Sinai, YHWH offered His covenant: "if you will indeed obey my voice and keep my covenant, then you shall be my own possession" (Exodus 19:5). The people answered with one voice:

All that YHWH has spoken we will do.

EXODUS 19:8

YHWH looks back on that moment and calls it a bride's love. Through Jeremiah, He says it plainly:

...which my covenant they broke, although I was a husband to them," says YHWH.

JEREMIAH 31:32

For your Maker is your husband; YHWH of Armies is his name. The Holy One of Israel is your Redeemer.

ISAIAH 54:5

The covering of the garment

Now when I passed by you, and looked at you, behold, your time was the time of love; and I spread my garment over you, and covered your nakedness. Yes, I pledged myself to you, and entered into a covenant with you," says Adonai YHWH, "and you became mine."

EZEKIEL 16:8

The word for garment here is **kanaf**, the corner or wing of a garment. It is the same picture Ruth used when she asked Boaz, her kinsman redeemer, to marry her:

Therefore spread the corner of your garment over your servant; for you are a near kinsman.

RUTH 3:9

Boaz had already blessed her by YHWH, "under whose wings you have come to take refuge" (Ruth 2:12), the same word again. And it is on the **kanaf**, the corners of the garment, that YHWH told Israel

to put the tzitzit with the blue cord (Numbers 15:38). In Scripture, spreading the corner of the garment over someone is a picture of covering, protecting, and covenant.

Hosea: the husband who would not give up

YHWH said to me, "Go again, love a woman loved by another, and an adulteress, even as YHWH loves the children of Israel, though they turn to other gods."

HOSEA 3:1

It will be in that day," says YHWH, "that you will call me 'my husband,' and no longer call me 'my master.'

HOSEA 2:16

In Hebrew: **Ishi**, my husband, not **Baali**, my master. YHWH does not want a bride who relates to Him like a servant to an owner. He wants a bride who knows Him as a Husband.

I will betroth you to me forever. Yes, I will betroth you to me in righteousness, in justice, in loving kindness, and in compassion. I will even betroth you to me in faithfulness; and you shall know YHWH.

HOSEA 2:19-20

KEY TRUTH

Every husband should read Hosea 2:19-20 as a job description: righteousness, justice, loving kindness, compassion, faithfulness. That is how YHWH husbands His people, and it is the standard He sets for ours.

SECTION VIII

Yahshua and Marriage

His first sign was at a wedding

This beginning of his signs Yahshua did in Cana of Galilee, and revealed his glory; and his disciples believed in him.

JOHN 2:11

Of all the places Yahshua could have first revealed His glory, He chose a wedding. He did not end the celebration; He saved it. And the master of the feast noticed that the best wine had been kept until last (John 2:10). That is what He does with marriages surrendered to Him.

He answered marriage questions with Genesis

When the Pharisees tested Him with the question, "Is it lawful for a man to divorce his wife for any reason?" (Matthew 19:3), Yahshua went back to the design:

Haven't you read that he who made them from the beginning made them male and female, and said, 'For this cause a man shall leave his father and mother, and shall be joined to his wife; and the two shall become one flesh?' So that they are no more two, but one flesh. What therefore Elohim has joined together, don't let man tear apart.

MATTHEW 19:4-6

Notice who does the joining: **Elohim**. A marriage is not only two people signing their names. It is something Elohim Himself joins.

He called Himself the Bridegroom

John the Immerser understood who Yahshua was in bridal terms: *"He who has the bride is the bridegroom"* (John 3:29). Yahshua called Himself the bridegroom (Matthew 9:15) and told the parable of the ten virgins waiting for the bridegroom to come (Matthew 25:1-13). And He spoke to His disciples like a bridegroom preparing a home:

In my Father's house are many homes. If it weren't so, I would have told you. I am going to prepare a place for you. If I go and prepare a place for you, I will come again, and will receive you to myself; that where I am, you may be there also.

JOHN 14:2-3

For I am jealous over you with a godly jealousy. For I married you to one husband, that I might present you as a pure virgin to Messiah.

2 CORINTHIANS 11:2

The mystery revealed

"For this cause a man will leave his father and mother and will be joined to his wife. Then the two will become one flesh." This mystery is great, but I speak concerning Messiah and the assembly.

EPHESIANS 5:31-32

KEY TRUTH

Genesis 2:24 was always about more than Adam and Eve. Paul says it was a mystery pointing to Yahshua and His bride. Your marriage is a living picture of that covenant, walking around in front of everyone who knows you.

SECTION IX

The Husband's Part

Husbands, love your wives, even as Messiah also loved the assembly, and gave himself up for it.

EPHESIANS 5:25

The standard is not "love her as much as she loves you" or "love her when she deserves it." The standard is how Yahshua loved His bride. In Ephesians 5:25-29 Paul names what He does: He **gave himself up** for her, He **sanctifies** her (sets her apart), He **cleanses** her with the washing of water by the word, He **presents** her glorious, and He **nourishes and cherishes** her. The companion handout *Husbands, Love Your Wives* takes each one in depth.

Guard and keep

Adam was given the garden to cultivate and to **shamar**, to guard (Genesis 2:15), before Eve was formed. A husband's first calling is to watch over what YHWH has put in his care: his wife's heart, his home's spiritual atmosphere, and what is allowed through the door.

Live with her according to knowledge

You husbands, in the same way, live with your wives according to knowledge, giving honor to the woman, as to the weaker vessel, as being also joint heirs of the grace of life, that your prayers may not be hindered.

1 PETER 3:7

Study your wife. Know her fears, her needs, what wounds her and what restores her. "Weaker vessel" is about how you handle her, the way you handle something precious, not about her worth: Peter calls her a **joint heir**, equal in the grace of life. And he gives a warning that should stop every husband: how you treat your wife affects whether your prayers are heard.

Do not be bitter, and make her glad

Husbands, love your wives, and don't be bitter against them.

COLOSSIANS 3:19

When a man takes a new wife, he shall not go out in the army, neither shall he be assigned any business. He shall be free at home one year, and shall cheer his wife whom he has taken.

DEUTERONOMY 24:5

YHWH wrote it into the instructions: the first year of marriage was protected so the husband could make his wife happy. Her joy was his assignment. And Proverbs adds, "*Rejoice in the wife of your youth*" (Proverbs 5:18).

FOR HUSBANDS

Headship in Scripture is measured by how much you lay down, not by how much you take. The head of the household goes first: first to repent, first to forgive, first to serve, first to pray.

SECTION X

The Wife's Part

...submitting yourselves to one another in the fear of Messiah. Wives, be subject to your own husbands, as to Adonai.

EPHESIANS 5:21-22

Read verse 21 before verse 22. Paul opens the whole passage by calling every believer to mutual submission. Then he speaks to wives, and the very next thing he does is put an even heavier weight on husbands: love her to the point of death.

Submission is not inferiority

But I would have you know that the head of every man is Messiah, and the head of the woman is the man, and the head of Messiah is Elohim.

1 CORINTHIANS 11:3

Yahshua is not less than the Father. Yet in the garden He prayed, "Nevertheless, not my will, but yours, be done" (Luke 22:42). Submission in Scripture is a choice made by an equal, out of trust and love. It is the same posture Messiah Himself took.

Respect

Nevertheless each of you must also love his own wife even as himself; and let the wife see that she respects her husband.

EPHESIANS 5:33

Paul tells the husband to love and the wife to respect. Many men can survive feeling unloved for a season far better than they can survive feeling disrespected. A wife who honors her husband in front of others and in private builds him up in a way nothing else can.

Strength that does him good

The heart of her husband trusts in her. He shall have no lack of gain. She does him good, and not harm, all the days of her life.

PROVERBS 31:11-12

The woman of Proverbs 31 is not timid. She buys a field, runs a household, works with her hands, and "Strength and dignity are her clothing" (Proverbs 31:25). Proverbs calls a worthy woman "the crown of

her husband" (Proverbs 12:4), and says "Whoever finds a wife finds good, and obtains favor of YHWH" (Proverbs 18:22).

...in the incorruptible adornment of a gentle and quiet spirit, which is very precious in the sight of Elohim.

1 PETER 3:4

Gentle and quiet does not mean silent or weak. Two verses later Peter says the daughters of Sarah "do well and are not put in fear by any terror" (1 Peter 3:6). It is a settled, unshaken strength that rests in YHWH, and Peter says it can win a husband over "without a word" (1 Peter 3:1).

AN IMPORTANT WORD

Submission to a husband never means following him into sin. "We must obey Elohim rather than men" (Acts 5:29). And it never means staying silent under abuse. Scripture calls husbands to lay their lives down, not to crush. If you are unsafe, reach out to a trusted leader and get to safety.

SECTION XI

One Flesh in Practice: Bed, Home, and Prayer

The marriage bed

Let marriage be held in honor among all, and let the bed be undefiled: but Elohim will judge the sexually immoral and adulterers.

HEBREWS 13:4

Let the husband give his wife the affection owed her, and likewise also the wife her husband. The wife doesn't have authority over her own body, but the husband does. Likewise also the husband doesn't have authority over his own body, but the wife does. Don't deprive one another, unless it is by consent for a season, that you may give yourselves to fasting and prayer, and may be together again, that Satan doesn't tempt you because of your lack of self-control.

1 CORINTHIANS 7:3-5

Notice how evenly Paul writes this. Every instruction runs in both directions: husband to wife and wife to husband. Intimacy is not a weapon, a reward, or a bargaining chip. It is part of the covenant, and Paul says withholding it opens a door to the enemy.

YHWH is not embarrassed by married love. He put a whole book about it in the Scriptures:

Set me as a seal on your heart, as a seal on your arm; for love is strong as death. Jealousy is as cruel as Sheol. Its flashes are flashes of fire, a very flame of YHWH. Many waters can't quench love, neither can floods drown it.

SONG OF SONGS 8:6-7

Guarding the eyes

Yahshua taught that looking at a woman to lust after her is adultery in the heart (Matthew 5:28). Job made a decision ahead of time: *"I made a covenant with my eyes; how then should I look lustfully at a young woman?"* (Job 31:1). Faithfulness is decided long before temptation shows up.

The home

...but as for me and my house, we will serve YHWH.

JOSHUA 24:15

These words, which I command you today, shall be on your heart; and you shall teach them diligently to your children, and shall talk of them when you sit in your house, and when you walk by the way, and when you lie down, and when you rise up.

DEUTERONOMY 6:6-7

Malachi said YHWH made husband and wife one because He was seeking godly offspring. The home is where faith is passed down: at the table, in the car, at bedtime.

Praying together

Again, assuredly I tell you, that if two of you will agree on earth concerning anything that they will ask, it will be done for them by my Father who is in heaven.

MATTHEW 18:19

There are no two people on earth better positioned to agree in prayer than a husband and wife who are one flesh. A couple who prays together is hard to divide.

SECTION XII

Forgiveness Keeps the Covenant

Two imperfect people cannot stay in covenant without forgiveness. It is not optional in marriage. It is the oil that keeps the whole thing from seizing up.

...bearing with one another, and forgiving each other, if any man has a complaint against any; even as Messiah forgave you, so you also do.

COLOSSIANS 3:13

"Be angry, and don't sin." Don't let the sun go down on your wrath, and don't give place to the devil.

EPHESIANS 4:26-27

Paul connects unresolved anger directly to giving the devil a place. A grudge carried into the night is an open door left unlocked in your house.

Yahshua said to him, "I don't tell you until seven times, but, until seventy times seven."

MATTHEW 18:22

Pride is the root

Pride only breeds quarrels, but with ones who take advice is wisdom.

PROVERBS 13:10

Elohim resists the proud, but gives grace to the humble.

JAMES 4:6

Kingdom Life holds this as a conviction: **pride is the root of unforgiveness, and humility is the root of forgiveness.** Pride is sneaky. In a marriage it rarely calls itself pride. It shows up as needing to be right, keeping score, the silent treatment, bringing up the past, or refusing to say "I was wrong" until the other one says it first.

Love is patient and is kind. Love doesn't envy. Love doesn't brag, is not proud, doesn't behave itself inappropriately, doesn't seek its own way, is not provoked, takes no account of evil.

1 CORINTHIANS 13:4-5

Takes no account of evil. Love does not keep a ledger. That does not mean pretending a wrong never happened. Forgiveness releases the debt; trust is rebuilt over time through changed behavior. You can forgive fully today and still be walking out the rebuilding of trust tomorrow.

FOR BOTH

The fastest way to heal a marriage is for the one who hears this teaching to go first. Do not wait for your spouse to humble themselves. Humble yourself, and watch what YHWH does with it.

SECTION XIII

The Enemy Hates This Picture

If marriage is a picture of Yahshua and His bride, then it makes sense that the enemy has attacked it from the beginning. He went after the first marriage in the garden. Paul warns that he still looks for openings in the marriage bed (1 Corinthians 7:5) and in unresolved anger (Ephesians 4:27).

Look where the armor passage sits

Ephesians 5:22 through 6:9 is all about the household: husbands and wives, children and parents, servants and masters. And then, with no break in thought:

Finally, be strong in Adonai, and in the strength of his might.

EPHESIANS 6:10

For our wrestling is not against flesh and blood, but against the principalities, against the powers, against the world's rulers of the darkness of this age, and against the spiritual forces of wickedness in the heavenly places.

EPHESIANS 6:12

The armor of Elohim comes right after the instructions for the home. The home is one of the first places you will need it.

Be sober and self-controlled. Be watchful. Your adversary, the devil, walks around like a roaring lion, seeking whom he may devour.

1 PETER 5:8

KEY TRUTH

Your spouse is not your enemy. Your spouse is flesh and blood, and your wrestling is not against flesh and blood. The one who whispered in the garden still whispers in houses today. Fight him together, not each other.

SECTION XIV

When the Covenant Is Broken

Some reading this have been through divorce. Some are walking through a broken covenant right now. This section is written with care, because Scripture speaks to this honestly and with more grace than many people have been shown.

YHWH's heart is restoration

Hosea took Gomer back. YHWH pursued Israel through the prophets for generations. Where reconciliation is possible and safe, it is always the first road: repentance, forgiveness, and rebuilding.

What Scripture actually says

He said to them, "Moses, because of the hardness of your hearts, allowed you to divorce your wives, but from the beginning it has not been so. I tell you that whoever divorces his wife, except for sexual immorality, and marries another, commits adultery."

MATTHEW 19:8-9

Divorce was never the design. It exists because of hardness of heart. But Yahshua Himself gives an exception, and that exception is deliberate. YHWH Himself speaks of giving a certificate of divorce:

I saw, when, for this very cause that backsliding Israel had committed adultery, I had put her away and given her a bill of divorce...

JEREMIAH 3:8

YHWH does not sin. When a covenant is broken by unfaithfulness, the one who was betrayed is not the covenant breaker. Paul adds that when an unbelieving spouse departs, "The brother or the sister is not under bondage in such cases, but Elohim has called us in peace" (1 Corinthians 7:15).

Kingdom Life holds this as a conviction from the text: **remarriage after a lawful divorce is permitted and is not adultery**. Deuteronomy 24:1-4 forbids the first husband from taking her back after she has married another; it does not forbid the remarriage itself. Romans 7:2-3 and 1 Corinthians 7:39 are illustrations Paul uses about being bound and released, not divorce legislation. And covenant breaking, not only death, ends a covenant (Jeremiah 3:8).

There is therefore now no condemnation to those who are in Messiah Yahshua, who don't walk according to the flesh, but according to the Spirit.

ROMANS 8:1

A WORD OF GRACE

If you carry the shame of a past marriage, hear this: the blood of Yahshua speaks louder than your history. Repent of what was yours, forgive what was theirs, and walk forward in the design.

SECTION XV

The Wedding at the End of the Story

The Bible opens with a wedding in a garden. It closes with a wedding in a city.

Let's rejoice and be exceedingly glad, and let's give the glory to him. For the wedding of the Lamb has come, and his wife has made herself ready. It was given to her that she would array herself in bright, pure, fine linen: for the fine linen is the righteous acts of the saints.

REVELATION 19:7-8

The bride makes herself ready, and her wedding garment is described as the righteous acts of the saints. Obedience is not how she earns the Bridegroom. It is how a bride who loves Him gets ready for Him.

Blessed are those who are invited to the wedding supper of the Lamb.

REVELATION 19:9

Kingdom Life holds as a conviction that the marriage supper of the Lamb is the Last Great Day, the eighth day after Tabernacles (Leviticus 23:36). Leviticus does not state this; it is offered as a conviction to test, not as a commandment.

I saw the holy city, New Jerusalem, coming down out of heaven from Elohim, made ready like a bride adorned for her husband.

REVELATION 21:2

The bride does not stay up and away. She **comes down**. The story ends with YHWH dwelling with His people on the earth, and an angel saying to John, "Come here. I will show you the bride, the Lamb's wife" (Revelation 21:9).

The Spirit and the bride say, "Come!"

REVELATION 22:17

THE LAST WORD

Every marriage on earth is a small picture of that final wedding. Husband, wife: your marriage is a sermon that people read before they ever open a Bible. Let it preach the Bridegroom who gave Himself and the bride who made herself ready.

REFERENCE

The Marriage Thread Through Scripture

PASSAGE	WHAT IT SHOWS
Genesis 1:27-28; 2:18-25	Marriage designed before the fall: helper comparable, leave, join, one flesh.
Genesis 3	The first attack on a marriage: silence, blame, and the struggle of 3:16.
Exodus 19; Jeremiah 2:2	Sinai remembered as a bride following her husband in the wilderness.
Ruth 3:9; Ezekiel 16:8	The corner of the garment spread over the bride: covering and covenant.
Song of Songs	Married love as a flame of YHWH, stronger than death.
Hosea 2-3	The faithful Husband who pursues and restores an unfaithful bride.
Malachi 2:14-16	YHWH as witness to the wife of your covenant; treachery condemned.
John 2:1-11	Yahshua's first sign at a wedding; the best wine saved for last.
Matthew 19:3-9	Yahshua answers marriage questions by going back to the beginning.
Ephesians 5:21-33	The mystery revealed: marriage pictures Messiah and His bride.
Revelation 19:7-9; 21:2, 9	The wedding of the Lamb; the bride comes down.

REFERENCE

Husband and Wife Side by Side

	THE CALLING	SCRIPTURE
Husband	Love her as Messiah loved the assembly	Ephesians 5:25
Husband	Guard and keep what YHWH placed in your care	Genesis 2:15
Husband	Live with her according to knowledge; honor her	1 Peter 3:7
Husband	Do not be bitter; make her glad	Colossians 3:19; Deuteronomy 24:5
Wife	Be the strength that stands face to face with him	Genesis 2:18
Wife	Respect your husband	Ephesians 5:33
Wife	Do him good and not harm all your days	Proverbs 31:12
Wife	A gentle and quiet spirit, unshaken by fear	1 Peter 3:4, 6
Both	Submit to one another in the fear of Messiah	Ephesians 5:21
Both	Forgive as Messiah forgave you	Colossians 3:13
Both	Do not deprive one another	1 Corinthians 7:3-5
Both	Honor the marriage bed	Hebrews 13:4
Both	Joint heirs of the grace of life	1 Peter 3:7

FOR COUPLES

Questions to Talk Through Together

1. Genesis 2:24 says leave, join, become one. Which of the three is the hardest for us right now, and why?
2. Where do we live like two people instead of one (money, schedules, decisions, friendships)?
3. Husband: what is one way you can guard and keep your home more faithfully this month?
4. Wife: what does it look like for you to be the strength that stands face to face with your husband, not behind him or over him?
5. Is there anything we are still keeping account of? What would it take to release it today?
6. Where does pride show up in our arguments? Who usually goes first to make peace, and could the other one go first next time?
7. How often do we pray together? What is one simple step to make it more regular?
8. If our marriage is a sermon people read, what is it preaching right now? What do we want it to preach?

A Prayer Over Your Marriage

PRAY TOGETHER

Yahshua, You designed marriage in the beginning and You called it good. We give our marriage back to You. Teach us to leave, to cling, and to be one. Where pride has built walls between us, humble us. Where we have kept account of wrongs, give us grace to release them tonight, before the sun goes down. Husband us both, so we know how to love each other. Guard our bed, our eyes, our words, and our home. Close every door we have opened to the enemy. Make our marriage a true picture of You and Your bride, so that everyone who sees it sees You. In Your name, Yahshua. Amen.

STUDY TOOL

Cross Reference Index

BOOK	REFERENCES IN THIS STUDY
Genesis	1:4-31; 1:27-28; 2:15; 2:18-25; 3:6-16; 4:7
Exodus	18:4; 19:5, 8; 20:12; 25:12; 26:20
Leviticus	23:36
Numbers	15:38
Deuteronomy	6:4, 6-7; 10:20; 24:1-5
Joshua	24:15
Ruth	1:14; 2:12; 3:9
Job	31:1
Psalms	33:20; 121:2
Proverbs	2:17; 5:18; 12:4; 13:10; 18:22; 31:11-12, 25
Ecclesiastes	4:9-12
Song of Songs	7:10; 8:6-7
Isaiah	54:5
Jeremiah	2:2; 3:8; 31:32
Ezekiel	16:8
Hosea	2:16, 19-20; 3:1
Malachi	2:14-16
Matthew	5:28; 9:15; 18:19, 22; 19:3-9; 25:1-13
Luke	22:42
John	2:1-11; 3:29; 14:2-3; 19:34
Acts	5:29
Romans	7:2-3; 8:1
1 Corinthians	7:3-5, 15, 39; 11:3; 13:4-5
2 Corinthians	11:2
Ephesians	4:26-27; 5:21-33; 6:10-12
Colossians	3:13, 19
Hebrews	13:4
James	4:6
1 Peter	3:1-7; 5:8
Revelation	19:7-9; 21:2, 9; 22:17

Notes

Walk in truth. Walk in Light. Shalom.